

Good Books

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Warm-up

"A book is a dream that you hold in your hand,"
said a famous writer, Neil Gaiman.

If you were to visit a book store which kind of books would
you choose? What will be the qualities of the 'good book' that
you choose? Tell your class about it.

Good books are friendly things to own.

If you are busy they will wait.

They will not call you on the phone,

Or wake you if the hour is late.

They stand together row by row,

Upon the low shelf or the high.

But if you're lonely, this you know—

You have a friend or two nearby.

The friendship of books is real.

They're never noisy when you're still.

They won't disturb you at your meal.

They'll comfort you when you are ill.

still
comfort

not moving
make you feel better





They'll help you pass the time away,

They'll give you advice if you need.

You have true friends for night and day,

If you have some good books to read.

pass the time away *spend time*



Understanding the Poem

(reading for main ideas)

A. Tick (✓) the right options to answer these questions. Work in pairs. Share your answers with your partner. Go through the poem once again before checking each other's answers.

- According to the poet, what do books do when you are busy?
 - They will force you to pick them up.
 - They will wait and not disturb you.
 - They will not be available later.
 - They will go to others who are free.
- When do they comfort you?

a. when you are alone	b. when you are lonely
c. when you are unwell	d. when you are bored

B. Answer these questions. Read the poem and check your answers.

- What kind of friends are good books?
- What would you do if you wanted their company?
- Why is their friendship thought to be real?

C. Think and answer.

CT

(reading for inference; HOTS)

- Mention two kinds of behaviour that the poet dislikes.
Do you think he prefers reading books to interacting with people?
- Books are patient and comforting. Explain how.



D. Discuss in class.



friendship



CT

(value-based question)

What are the qualities shared by a good friend and a good book?





Appreciation

In most poems, the rhyming lines form a pattern. This pattern is known as the **rhyme scheme**. Rhyme schemes make a poem sound musical. The scheme is formed by using letters to indicate which lines rhyme.

Good books are friendly things to own. (A)

If you are busy they will wait. (B)

They will not call you on the phone, (A)

Or wake you if the hour is late. (B)

Thus, the rhyme scheme of the first stanza is **ABAB**.

A. Now, write the rhyme scheme of the second stanza of the poem.

Show your answer to your teacher and find out if it is correct. 

The poet refers to books almost as if they are his friends. This is known as **personification**, where a non-living thing is given the status of a living person.

B. Read through the poem and pick out examples of personification.  **CT**



Life Skills Activity

(interpersonal skills; critical thinking)

Hold book talks in class. Each student has to talk about a book that he/she has read and enjoyed. The idea is to share ideas and make your friends interested in what you are reading.  **COM** **CT**

Here are some points to keep in mind.

- title of book
- name of author
- type of book (a folktale, a fairy tale, a myth, a detective story, etc.)
- where you found the book and why you chose it
- storyline

Be careful not to give away what happens at the end.

